QUICK-COMMERCE AVAILABILITY AUDIT: INSTAMART VS BLINKIT

12 of 30 items were unavailable on Instamart. On Blinkit, 1 was

VIZAG · 30 EVERYDAY ITEMS · 23 OCT 2026

SAI SANJANA.Y

PROBLEM

DOES AVAILABILITY MATTER MORE THAN PRICE?

- 30 SPECIFIC GROCERY ITEMS ACROSS 5 CATEGORIES
- CHECKED ON BOTH APPS IN VIZAG AT ABOUT 7PM
- LOGGED PRICE AND WHETHER I COULD ADD EACH ITEM TO CART
- “UNAVAILABLE” MEANS SOLD OUT OR NOT LISTED

FINDINGS

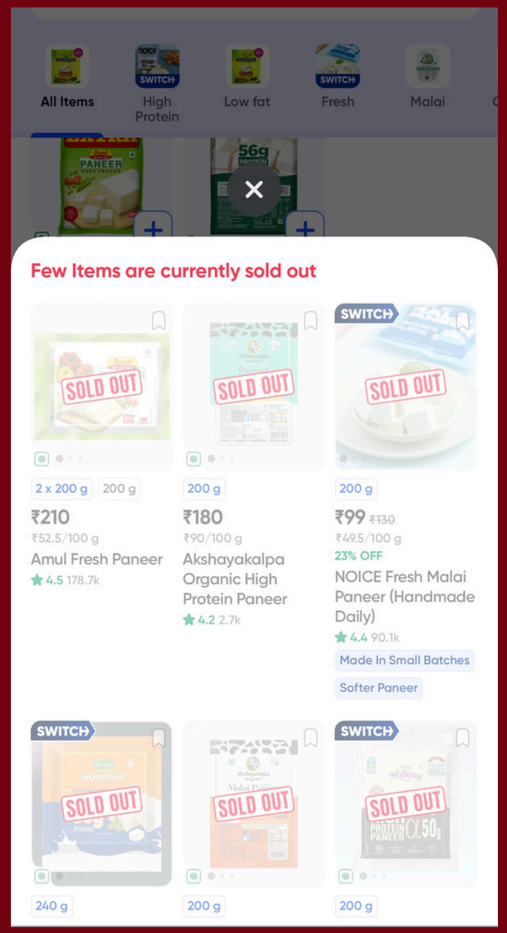
FINDING 1

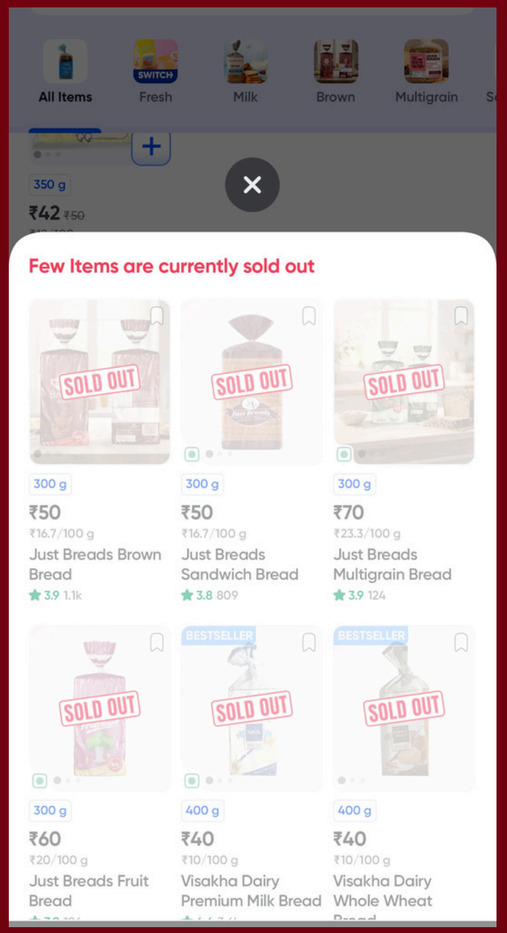
- Availability is where the apps differ
- 60% Instamart · 97% Blinkit
- Items I could add to cart (18 of 30 vs 29 of 30)
- These are the exact items I searched for, not whole categories.

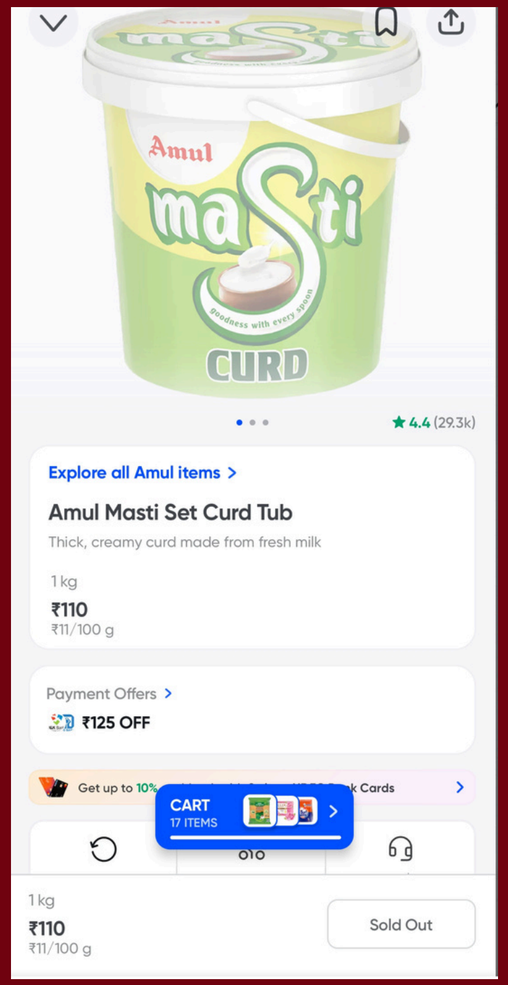
FINDING 2

- Prices are almost identical
- ₹1,453 Instamart · ₹1,444 Blinkit
- Same 18 items, in stock on both. Difference: 0.6%.
- 6 items cheaper on each app, 6 tied.
- Price is not what separates the two apps.

EVIDENCE

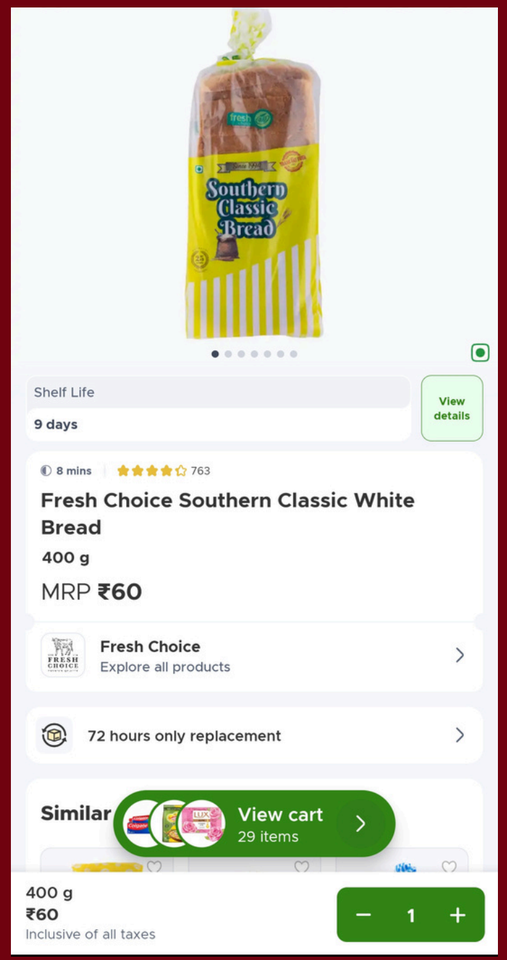


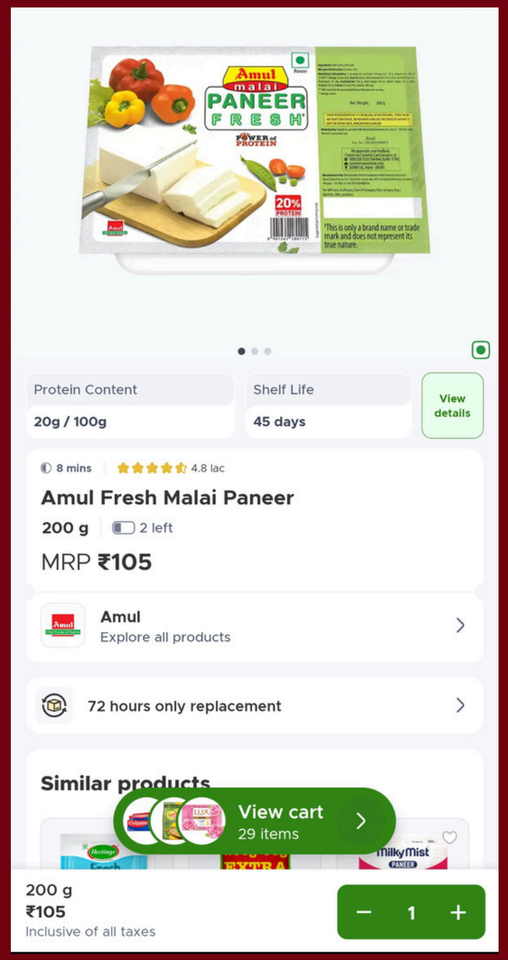


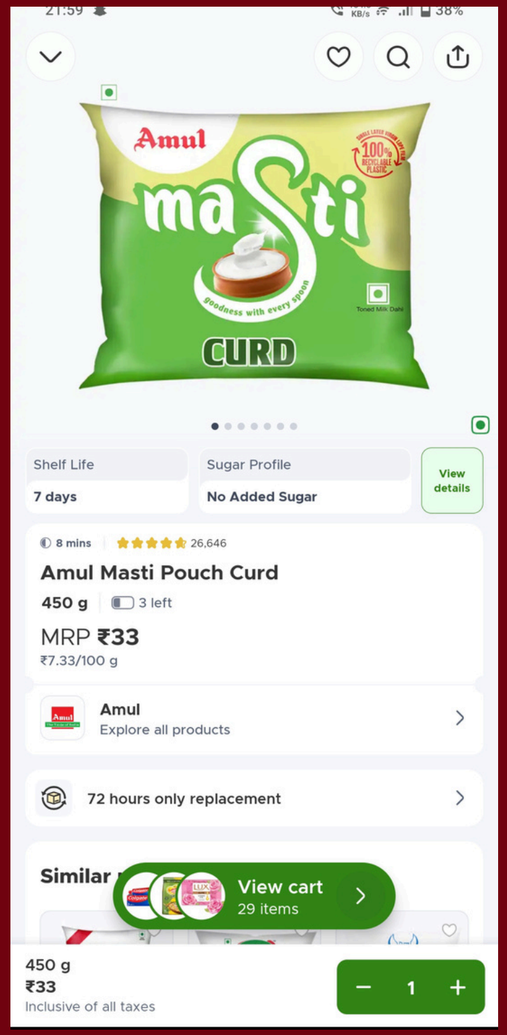


- INSTAMART: EXACT ITEMS SOLD OUT OR NOT LISTED, I HAD TO SCROLL TO LEARN THE EXACT ITEM WAS SOLD OUT. BLINKIT LABELED IT OUT OF STOCK IN THE RESULTS.
- CURD: “INSTAMART DOESN’T LIST THE 450 G POUCH; THE NEAREST ITEM, THE 1 KG TUB, IS SOLD OUT.”
- BREAD: “FRESH CHOICE NOT AVAILABLE; OTHER BRANDS SHOWN SOLD OUT.”
- PANEER: “AMUL FRESH PANEER SOLD OUT.”

EVIDENCE





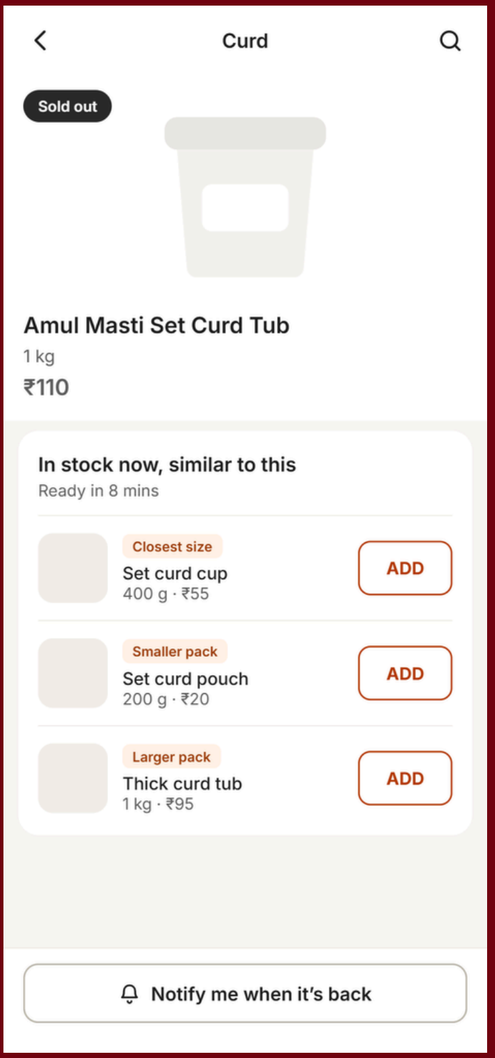


- BLINKIT: IN STOCK, BUT “3 LEFT” ON CURD AND “2 LEFT” ON PANEER

PROPOSED FIX

When an item is unavailable, say so up front and offer matched alternatives

- **HYPOTHESIS:** TELLING SHOPPERS UP FRONT THAT AN ITEM IS UNAVAILABLE, AND SHOWING MATCHED IN-STOCK ALTERNATIVES, INCREASES PURCHASES.
- **SUCCESS METRIC:** CHECKOUT COMPLETION RATE IN SESSIONS THAT HIT AN UNAVAILABLE ITEM
- **GUARDRAIL:** CANCELLATION AND SUBSTITUTION COMPLAINT RATE
- **DECISION RULE:** SHIP IF COMPLETION RISES BY AT LEAST 3 POINTS WITH NO GUARDRAIL REGRESSION AFTER 2 WEEKS



(Concept mock, sample products)

LIMITS AND NEXT STEPS

LIMITS

- One city, one time slot, one run
- Screenshots were taken later than the data
- Instamart prices reflect a Swiggy One membership
- Blinkit’s low stock means its 97% is a snapshot

NEXT

- repeat at different times of day, add Zepto, and test whether substitutes reduce drop-off.

THANK YOU

DATA LINK : OPEN THE EXCEL SHEET